



THE NUMBER OF INDIAN TOURISTS VISITING RAS AL KHAIMAH INCREASED 20% LAST YEAR

World Records.

Starting at a thrilling altitude of 1,680 metres above the Arabian Gulf, adrenaline junkies can take in stunning views as they zip down the 2,832-metre-long line. During the three-minute ride, you can reach speeds of up to 160 km per hour. "I felt like a bird," said a friend after the adventure. However, I had no intention of flying except in a plane, and so instead I enjoyed a bite at 1484 by Puro, the UAE's highest restaurant, with spectacular views of the Hajar mountains and valleys below.

For those who seek more than

one adventure in a day, there is also the Jais Sledder, a specially designed sledge that takes you swerving through 1,840 hairpin curves at a comfortable top speed of 40 km per hour.

LOOK MA, I'M FLYING

Unlike the zip line, this is literal. The Jazirah Aviation Club offers sightseeing flights on tiny two-seater aircraft that at first glance don't inspire much confidence, especially since they are coloured hot pink, bright blue, and sunshine yellow. However, the pilots are

HIGH-SPEED ESCAPE Jais Flight holds the Guinness World Record for the world's longest zip line. During the three-minute ride, you can reach speeds of up to 160 km per hour

well trained with several hours of flying time, and a one-on-one session of learning to fly a plane with them is quite memorable.

The best way to reach RAK is to fly into Dubai and then drive down to the emirate. IndiGo also launched a direct flight from Mumbai to RAK last year.

In 2023, RAK welcomed the highest number of overnight arrivals of 1.22 million visitors, surpassing the earlier record of 1.13 million visitors in 2022. With the number of visitors growing and RAK fast becoming a tourist destination, maybe in a couple of years, my aunt won't ask, "Where is that?" **BT**

@smitabw